

SENATE RESOLUTION 5

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Dr. Priscilla Davis on the celebration of her eightieth birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Priscilla Davis will celebrate her eightieth birthday this year, a milestone that will be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Davis, at the age of only nine, demonstrated fearless courage and perseverance in her fight with polio, even after her doctors told her that she would be unable to use her right arm for the rest of her life; she struggled through recuperation without a physical therapist due to segregation, and she managed to make a complete recovery and go on to live an active life; and

WHEREAS, she studied at both the University of Buffalo and Buffalo State University, earning her doctorate in communicative disorders, and went on to teach for over thirty years combined at the University of Arkansas at Little Rock and the University of Arkansas for Medical Sciences; and

WHEREAS, a tireless advocate and laborer for those who experience auditory or linguistic difficulties, Dr. Davis was a member of the American Speech-Language-Hearing Association for forty-five years; and

WHEREAS, she moved to teach at the University of Alabama, where she, for over a decade, enlightened her students in such subjects as speech development, articulation disorders, multicultural issues, diagnostics, and phonetics; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Davis exhibited her aptitude for effective leadership at the University of Alabama as a member of the Faculty Senate, the chairman of the Promotion and Tenure Committee, and the president of the Black Faculty and Staff Association; and

WHEREAS, committed to racial equality on campus and beyond, she served as the faculty advisor to the NAACP; and

WHEREAS, as she enters her eightieth year, Dr. Davis, admired for her wisdom, spirit of generosity, integrity, and enthusiasm for life, still exudes the goodness that is so characteristically hers; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we hereby honor and congratulate Dr. Priscilla Davis on the celebration of her eightieth birthday and extend to her our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.